

Complete, end-to-end sales playbook tailored for selling **Zapier + n8n automation services**. It's structured so you can deploy it immediately—scripts, templates, cadences, checklists, KPIs, and SOPs included.

Full Sales Playbook: Zapier & n8n Automation Services

Purpose: Equip you (and your team) to consistently generate leads, close deals, and expand accounts for automation projects across startups, SMBs, agencies, and enterprise IT.

0) Your Offer at a Glance (Anchor Your Messaging)

- **Core Outcomes:** Save time, reduce errors, scale ops without hiring, faster SLAs, audited data flows.
 - **Services:**
 - Zapier workflow builds & optimization
 - n8n (cloud/self-hosted) orchestration & DevOps
 - Process mapping & automation roadmaps
 - API integrations, webhooks, data sync
 - Maintenance & monitoring retainers
 - **Signature Entry Offer: Free 15-minute Automation Audit** → "I'll find 3–7 workflows that save 5–20 hours/week."
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1) ICP, Positioning & Messaging

Ideal Customer Profiles (ICPs)

1. **Startup operators / Founders** (tools: HubSpot/Airtable/Slack/Stripe)
2. **Agencies** (marketing/web/dev shops needing white-label automation)
3. **SMB Ops / RevOps managers** (CRM, billing, reporting headaches)
4. **Enterprise IT / Data / Ops** (n8n self-hosting, governance, security)

Positioning Statements

- **General:** “We design reliable automation systems with Zapier & n8n so you can scale without adding headcount.”
- **Agency:** “Your behind-the-scenes automation partner—white-label workflows that make your clients stay longer.”
- **Enterprise:** “Low-code orchestration with n8n, built to your security and compliance standards.”

Messaging Pillars (use everywhere)

- **Reliability & Monitoring** (not just “build a Zap”)
 - **Documented, diagrammed systems** (executive confidence)
 - **Business impact** (hours saved, revenue unlocked)
 - **Scalability & governance** (esp. for n8n self-hosted)
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2) Packaging & Pricing Framework (for Sales Conversations)

Entry: Quick Win (2–5 workflows, 72 hours) – \$499–\$1,250

Core: Growth System (10–15 workflows, docs) – \$1,500–\$4,500

Advanced: n8n Self-Hosted Setup – \$2,000–\$5,000 (enterprise \$8k–\$25k+)

Recurring: Maintenance & Monitoring – \$299–\$7,500/mo (tiered SLAs)

Sales Principle: Present **two clear options** (Quick Win vs Growth) to reduce friction and increase conversions.

3) Go-to-Market Channels & Weekly Cadence

Core Channels

- **LinkedIn:** Daily micro-content + DM outreach
- **Communities:** Reddit, Indie Hackers, CRM/No-Code groups (answer questions)
- **Partnerships:** Agencies (white-label), MSPs, boutique dev shops
- **Marketplaces/Job Boards:** Upwork, niche boards (use case-led proposals)
- **Email:** Cold & warm outbound to niche lists

Weekly Activity Plan (Solo Operator)

- 3–4 LinkedIn posts + 1 short demo video
 - 150–250 targeted DMs/emails
 - 3 community threads answered (with value)
 - 2 partner calls (agencies/MSPs)
 - 3 audit calls booked, 2 proposals sent
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4) Outreach Scripts & Sequences

A) LinkedIn Connection + DM (founder/operator)

Connect note (≤ 280 chars):

"Noticed you're using [HubSpot/Slack/Stripe]. I build Zapier & n8n automations that save 5–20 hours/week. Open to a free 10–15 min audit where I show 3 workflows you can ship fast?"

Follow-up #1 (2 days):

"Quick example: Form → CRM → Slack → Task creation saved a client ~8 hrs/week. Want me to outline 3 similar ideas for your stack?"

Follow-up #2 (4 days):

"Can I send a 2-minute Loom on what I'd automate first? No commitment—just ideas."

B) Cold Email (SMB/Agency)

Subject: Quick win ideas for your [CRM/ops]

Body:

"Hi {{Name}},

I help {{ICP}} automate repetitive ops with Zapier & n8n.

Looked at {{their tools/website}}—I see 3 quick wins:

1. {{Lead routing idea}}
2. {{Invoice/collections idea}}
3. {{Slack alerts/QA idea}}

Happy to walk you through in a 10–15 min audit—no pitch.

– {{You}}, {{Title}} | {{Site}}"

Follow-ups (3–5 touches):

- Send a Loom with 1 workflow diagram.
- Share a 1-pager case snapshot (hours saved).
- Offer "build one micro-automation free" (capped).

5) The Discovery Call (15 minutes, tight)

Goal: Quantify pain, stack, and ROI. Offer **two options** and book next step.

Agenda (stick to it):

1. Context & tools (2 min)
2. Pain inventory: what's manual? what breaks? (5 min)
3. Quantify: hours/week + impact (3 min)
4. Map 2–3 workflows (3 min)
5. Present next step: Quick Win vs Growth (2 min)

Key Questions

- "What's the most repetitive task your team does every week?"
- "What breaks most often today?"
- "If we remove this, what's the impact on revenue/CSAT/SLAs?"

Close

- "We can start with a Quick Win in 72 hours or go straight to Growth System. Which fits better?"

6) Free Audit Structure (High-Conversion Asset)

Deliverable (one-page deck or email + 2-min Loom):

- Summary: 3–7 opportunities
- Visuals: mini swimlane diagram(s)
- Estimate: time saved / month
- Risk: where things break today
- Plan: what we'll build in 2 weeks
- CTA: fixed price + start date + two package options

Pro tip: Send the audit within 24–48 hours of the call.

7) Proposal & Pricing Best Practices

- Keep it **short** (5–7 pages).
- Always include: **scope, timeline, deliverables, assumptions, pricing, maintenance option, acceptance.**
- **Payment:** 50% upfront, 50% on delivery (or milestone-based for enterprise).
- Include **diagram** and **1–2 screenshots** of similar flows.
- Add **maintenance upsell box** (monitoring + updates + alerting).

Email wrapper (simple):

"Attached is the scope for your {{department}} automations. If you'd like, we can kick off with the Quick Win as early as {{date}}. I've penciled a slot—shall I hold it?"

8) Objections & Rebuttals (Scripts)

1. **"We can do it in-house."**
"Totally fair. Most teams can, but rarely prioritize it. We bring a library of templates and lessons learned—so you get it done right the first time and avoid months of tinkering."
 2. **"Zapier/n8n might break."**
"That's exactly why we add monitoring, alerts, and fallback logic. You're buying reliability, not just a Zap."
 3. **"Budget is tight."**
"Then let's start with a Quick Win package. It typically pays for itself in 4–6 weeks via saved hours."
 4. **"Security/compliance?"**
"For n8n we can do self-hosting with RBAC, audit logging, key management, and restricted network policies. We'll document data flows for your compliance team."
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9) Closing Techniques

- **Two-option close:** "Quick Win now vs Growth next month?"
- **Implementation calendar:** "I have {{two slots}} left this week. Want me to hold one?"
- **ROI anchor:** "This saves ~{{X}} hours/month. At \${{Y}} loaded cost/hour, the payback is ~{{Z}} weeks."

If stalled:

Offer a **paid pilot** (discounted, fast) or a **free micro-automation** (1 hour) with a clear boundary.

10) Onboarding & Delivery (Hand-off from Sales)

Checklist (send upon signature):

- Access list: tools, accounts, API keys, staging data
- Security form: PII rules, credential sharing, allowed IPs
- Workflow priorities confirmed
- Slack/Teams channel created
- Key contacts: business owner & technical owner
- Kickoff call: review scope, success metrics, comms cadence

Client-facing milestones:

1. Blueprint (diagrams + logic)
2. Build (dev/stage)
3. UAT (client testing)
4. Launch (production)
5. Documentation & training
6. Maintenance handoff

11) Expansion & Retention (Land & Expand)

At delivery:

- Show **backlog** of “phase 2” ideas.
- Offer **maintenance tier** with SLA.
- Propose **quarterly automation roadmap** review.

90-day expansion plays:

- Add AI steps (classification, enrichment, summarization)
- Introduce API-level connectors
- Add alerting, reporting dashboards
- Onboard adjacent departments (Support, Finance, Ops)

Referral ask (exact line):

“Do you know any founder/ops lead who’s struggling with manual processes? I’d be happy to run the same 15-minute audit for them.”

12) Partner Strategy (High-Leverage)

Targets:

- Marketing & dev agencies (white-label)
- MSPs & boutique IT firms (n8n orchestration)
- CRM implementers (HubSpot/Zoho/Salesforce boutiques)

Partner offer:

- Revenue share (10–20%)
- Private Slack channel + guaranteed response times
- Co-branded collateral and packaged automations

Partner enablement pack:

- 3 one-page use-case briefs
- 2 demo Looms
- Menu of fixed packages

13) Metrics, KPIs & Pipeline Hygiene

Top-of-funnel:

- Contacts added/week
- Conversations started/week
- Audit calls booked (target: 5–10/week)

Mid-funnel:

- Audit → Proposal conversion rate (target: 60–80%)
- Proposal → Win rate (target: 35–55%)
- Average sales cycle (days)

Post-sale:

- Time-to-first automation shipped (days)
- NPS / CSAT
- % clients on retainer (target: 40–60%)

- Net revenue retention (NRR) > 110%

Pipeline stages (with exit criteria):

1. **New Lead** (contacted, not spoken)
2. **Discovery Booked** (calendar invite sent)
3. **Audit Delivered** (artifact shared)
4. **Proposal Sent** (pricing + scope)
5. **Verbal Yes** (start date agreed)
6. **Closed-Won** (invoice paid)
7. **Onboarding**
8. **Active Delivery**
9. **Retainer/Expansion**

SLA targets:

- First reply $\leq$ 4 business hours
- Proposal $\leq$ 48 hours post-audit
- First deliverable $\leq$ 7–10 days

14) Compliance, Security & Risk Notes (Enterprise-Ready)

- **Credentials:** use a vault (1Password/Bitwarden), share via secure links
- **Data handling:** define PII scope, retention policy, and logs
- **n8n self-hosted:** RBAC, HTTPS, backups, audit logs, IP allowlists
- **Docs:** data flow diagrams; change logs; runbooks; error-handling playbooks

Sales tip: Include a 1-page “Security & Architecture Summary” with enterprise proposals.

15) Assets & Templates Library

A) Email / DM Templates

- **Intro:** (from §4)
- **Bump:** “Still up for a 10–15 min audit? I can send a Loom first.”
- **Close:** “Can I hold {{date/time}} to start your Quick Win?”

B) Audit Deck Outline (1-pager)

- Current state pains
- 3–7 opportunities (each with quick diagram + time saved)
- Architecture sketch (Zapier vs n8n)
- Timeline & price (two options)
- CTA & start date

C) Proposal Template (Short)

Project: Zapier + n8n Automation

Scope: Build [X] workflows, [Y] systems, docs, training

Timeline: [X] days total

Price: \$_____ (50% upfront, 50% on delivery)

Maintenance: \$_____/mo (monitoring + updates + SLA)

Assumptions: Access provided, 3rd-party fees separate

Acceptance: Client name / Signature / Date

D) Call Agendas

- **Discovery (15 min):** tools → pains → quantify → options → next step
- **Kickoff (30 min):** goals → success metrics → access → comms → risks
- **Handover (30 min):** docs → training → maintenance → roadmap

E) Case Study Template

- Client context
- Problem (manual steps, risks)
- Solution (architecture + screenshots)
- Result (hours saved, errors reduced, SLA impact)
- Quote/testimonial
- Next-phase roadmap

16) Content Engine (Supports the Funnel)

Weekly content ideas (LinkedIn + blog):

- "Before/After" workflow posts (1-minute demo)
- "3 automations for {{niche}} that save {{X}} hours"
- "What breaks most—and how to prevent it"

- “Zapier vs n8n: when to choose which”
- “How we monitor and alert automations like SREs”

CTA on every post:

“DM ‘AUDIT’ for a 10–15 min free workflow review.”

17) Internal SOPs (to Scale Without Chaos)

Sales SOPs:

- Respond within SLA, log every touch in CRM
- Discovery template questions, no exceptions
- Proposal within 48 hours of audit
- Use library of diagrams & snippets to speed up

Delivery SOPs:

- Branching logic conventions
 - Error handling & fallback nodes
 - Alerting to Slack/Email on failures
 - Versioning & change logs
 - Documentation minimums (diagram + runbook + credentials map)
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18) 30/60/90 Day Sales Targets (Solo)

- **Days 1–30:**
 - 500+ outbound touches
 - 10–20 audits
 - 3–5 projects closed
 - **Days 31–60:**
 - 2–3 retainers added
 - 2 enterprise discovery convos
 - **Days 61–90:**
 - \$8k–\$15k MRR run-rate (mix of projects + retainers)
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Appendices (Copy-Paste Ready)

A) “5-Minute Discovery” Script

Thanks for the time—quickly:

- 1) Tools you rely on daily?
- 2) Most repetitive task (weekly)?
- 3) What breaks most? Where do errors happen?
- 4) If we automate 1-2 of these, impact on hours/revenue/SLAs?

Here are 2 workflows I’d start with and why (diagram).

Two ways to proceed:

- Quick Win (72 hrs, \$___)
- Growth System (2-3 weeks, \$___)

Which feels right?

B) “Loom Audit” Script (90–120 seconds)

Intro (10s): I reviewed your stack (X, Y, Z).

Pain (20s): These steps are manual and error-prone (examples).

Opportunities (40s): 3 quick wins + estimated hours saved.

Plan (20s): Architecture sketch, alerts, docs.

CTA (10s): Quick Win vs Growth. I can start on [date].

C) “Proposal Email” (Short)

Subject: Scope & start date for your automations

Hi {{Name}},

Attached is the scope for phase 1 ({{workflows}}).

Two options:

- Quick Win (72 hrs): \$___
- Growth System (2-3 weeks): \$___

I can start {{date}}. Want me to hold the slot?

Best,

{{You}}

D) “Referral Ask” (After Success)

We loved working on this and the results look strong.

Do you know a founder/ops lead who struggles with manual processes?

Happy to give them the same 15-min audit—no pressure.
